

Sunday Dinner — Miso-Roasted Salmon

Serves 3 (Jin, Hui Fong — moderate carb; Lukas — full portion) · Arrival 4:15–4:30 · Service 5:30 · Oven: 425°F / 218°C conventional

- Miso-roasted salmon, centre-cut, skin lifted at plating
- Roasted broccolini, sesame
- Steamed Japanese short-grain rice
- Cucumber sunomono

Workflow Notes

Critical path is the rice cooker. It must be loaded within 10 minutes of walking in the door; everything else aligns to it. The salmon and broccolini together occupy only the final 20 minutes. Protect the salmon: rice holds on Keep Warm indefinitely and broccolini holds uncovered, so if timing slips, those two absorb it. Nothing waits on the fish.

The oven runs a single state throughout — 425°F / 218°C conventional, lower-middle rack, no transitions. One half-sheet serves both roasted components, staggered: broccolini enters at T-20, the tray comes out briefly at T-15 to receive the salmon, then returns. Work quickly with the tray on the stovetop, not on the open door, and return it immediately — the brief interruption is already absorbed in the stated cooking bands. If running convection, drop to 400°F / 205°C and expect the salmon at the short end of its band. Rice runs unattended start to finish on the Tiger; the cucumber is fully complete before the oven is used. No cooktop burner is required, and outdoor gas and binchotan stay idle.

Ahead of the Day

Portion the salmon the night before or Sunday morning, not at 4:30. Cut the centre section into three portions of equal thickness rather than equal weight — a side tapers, so cut narrower from the thick end and wider from the thin end so all three finish at the same height. Thickness, not weight, drives the cooking band and the probe reading; if the portions cannot be brought within ¼ in / 6 mm of each other, probe the thickest and accept that the thinnest runs slightly past. Run a finger down the centre line and pull the pin bones with tweezers or needle-nose pliers, following the direction they lean rather than pulling straight up. Trim the belly flap.

Salt at that point — ½ tsp total, weighted to the underside — and hold the portions skin-down on a rack over a tray, uncovered, in the fridge. The overnight uncovered rest dries the surface better than the 15-minute cure does, so it replaces that step rather than adding to it. If this is not done ahead, fall back to the T-58 salting step below.

T-Minus Timeline

T-minus	Action
T-60 (4:30)	Rinse 1½ cooker cups rice to near-clear; into Tiger, water to line 1½, Plain setting. Runs ~50 min, then Keep Warm.
T-58	Only if not portioned ahead: salt salmon lightly (½ tsp, weighted to the underside); skin-down on a rack over a plate, uncovered, fridge. 15 min — off the critical path.
T-55	Whisk glaze. Set aside.
T-53	Slice cucumber, salt, drain in colander. 15 min.
T-40 (4:50)	Oven to 425°F / 218°C, rack lower-middle. ~15 min to temperature.
T-38	Line half-sheet with parchment. Trim and toss broccolini; spread across one end only, leaving the other end clear.
T-36	Squeeze cucumber, dress, sesame. Fridge; ~30 min designed hold.
T-25 (5:05)	Salmon out of fridge, pat both faces dry, glaze thinly.
T-20 (5:10)	Tray into oven.
T-15 (5:15)	Tray out onto stovetop. Salmon skin-down on the clear end. Straight back in. Salmon 9–11 min.
T-6 to T-4	Tray out. Salmon pulled at 122°F / 50°C. Broccolini tossed with sesame oil and seeds while hot.
T-6 to T-4	Salmon rests on warm plates, uncovered. 3–4 min.
T-3	Fluff rice, lid back on. Drain any liquid from the cucumber.
T-0	Lift each fillet off its skin with a fish slice; plate. Lemon wedges to table.

Variance-band closure. Earliest finish T-6 gives a 4-minute rest, plating at T-2 and a 2-minute hold — inside the salmon's designed 5–8 minute window. Latest finish T-4 gives a 4-minute rest to T-0 and immediate plating; realistic service in that case is 5:32 with no plating buffer. Both ends close. The late edge has no slack, which is

why the broccolini and rice absorb any slip and the salmon never does. Broccolini total lands at 14–16 minutes on parchment, against 12–14 on bare metal.

Holding Chain

Component	Hold Strategy	Designed Max	Drift	Corrective
Rice	Tiger, Keep Warm, lid closed	Indefinite	Surface dries at the lid	Fluff at T-3, lid back on
Broccolini	Tray, uncovered, on stovetop	~15–20 min	Softens if covered	Never cover
Cucumber	Sealed, fridge	~30 min	Weeps; dressing dilutes	Drain at T-3 — mandatory, not conditional
Salmon	Warm plate, uncovered	~5–8 min	Surface goes tacky, flesh firms	None — plate it

Hold windows are designed, not validated. Planning targets, not cliffs.

Meal Balance Audit

Richness sits entirely in the salmon and is capped three ways — centre-cut selection (the dominant lever), a thin glaze, and skin removal at plating (a mouthfeel gain rather than a large reduction in total fat, since most salmon fat is intramuscular). Salt is deliberately consolidated in the glaze rather than layered: the fillet carries only ½ tsp, weighted to the unglazed face, so the miso and soy set the exterior level without stacking.

Acidity appears in three components in functionally distinct roles — rice vinegar in the glaze builds depth against the miso, the sunomono resets between bites, and the lemon wedge is a per-diner brightness control, which is the correct lever for Lukas specifically. Texture runs soft salmon, yielding rice, firm broccolini, cool crisp-tender cucumber. Sweetness is confined to the mirin and 1 tsp in the sunomono — no stacking. Aromatic interest is split deliberately: ginger on the fish, sesame on the vegetable, so neither dominates. No heat, no smoke. Register: restrained Sunday, not occasion cooking.

Post-cook confirmation candidate: the 3°F / 2°C carryover delta over a 3–4 minute uncovered rest on a 5–6 oz centre-cut portion from a 425°F oven. Designed, not validated — log the observed figure after this cook.

Shared Prep

Rice vinegar: 3 tbsp total — 1 tsp → Salmon glaze, 2 tbsp + 2 tsp → Cucumber

Toasted sesame seeds: 2 tsp total — 1 tsp → Broccolini, 1 tsp → Cucumber

No other ingredient appears in two or more components in a form that can sensibly be prepared in aggregate. Ginger is grated for the glaze only; the two sesame applications differ (seeds on both, oil on the broccolini alone) and are listed separately in each dish.

Shopping List

Ingredient	Total	Salmon	Broccolini	Cucumber	Rice
PROTEIN					
Salmon, centre section of a side, skin-on	1¼ lb / 570 g	✓	—	—	—
PRODUCE					
Broccolini	12 oz / 340 g	—	12 oz / 340 g	—	—
Cucumber, Japanese or Persian	2	—	—	2	—
Ginger, fresh	1 tsp grated	1 tsp	—	—	—
Lemon	1	1 (wedges)	—	—	—
PANTRY / DRY					
Rice, Japanese short-grain <i>(pantry check)</i>	1½ cooker cups / ~225 g	—	—	—	✓
Sesame seeds, toasted <i>(pantry check)</i>	2 tsp	—	1 tsp	1 tsp	—
Sugar <i>(pantry check)</i>	1 tsp	—	—	1 tsp	—
FRIDGE / DAIRY					
Miso, white (shiro)	2 tbsp / 36 g	2 tbsp	—	—	—
OILS & LIQUIDS					
Mirin <i>(pantry check)</i>	1 tbsp	1 tbsp	—	—	—
Oil, neutral <i>(pantry check)</i>	1½ tbsp / 20 g	—	1½ tbsp	—	—
Rice vinegar <i>(pantry check)</i>	3 tbsp	1 tsp	—	2 tbsp + 2 tsp	—
Sake <i>(pantry check)</i>	1 tbsp	1 tbsp	—	—	—
Sesame oil, toasted <i>(pantry check)</i>	½ tsp	—	½ tsp	—	—
Soy sauce <i>(pantry check)</i>	2 tsp	2 tsp	—	—	—
SEASONING					
Salt, Diamond Crystal kosher <i>(pantry check)</i>	2 tsp	½ tsp	½ tsp	1 tsp	—

Sourcing Notes

Buy the centre section of a side rather than pre-cut fillets. Counters routinely portion across the whole side, so one of three pre-cut fillets is often quietly a tail piece — and cut selection is the single biggest lever on the richness constraint. Ask for roughly 1¼ lb / 570 g off the middle of the side, skin on; the extra 4 oz over the 1 lb / 450 g needed absorbs trim loss. If buying a whole side (2.5–3.5 lb / 1.1–1.6 kg), portion it all at once: surplus centre portions freeze well wrapped tight, and the belly and tail are better used for tartare, rice bowls, or poached flake than roasted — they are the pieces removed for a reason.

Ora King or Tasmanian if available; otherwise centre-cut Atlantic. Skin-on is strongly preferred for handling and clean release, though skinless centre-cut on parchment remains executable. Japanese or Persian cucumber only — field cucumber carries too much seed and water. Smallwares: tweezers or needle-nose pliers for pin bones; instant-read thermometer.

1 · Miso-Roasted Salmon

Yield: 3 · Total: ~40 min · Active: ~10 min · Oven: 425°F / 218°C

A thin savoury-sweet miso lacquer over centre-cut salmon, roasted hot and fast so the surface caramelises before the interior fat renders into the flesh: silky at the centre, with a set — not sticky — glazed surface.

Ingredient	Amount
Salmon, centre-cut, skin-on, cut to equal thickness	3 portions, 5–6 oz / 140–170 g each
Salt, Diamond Crystal kosher	½ tsp
GLAZE	
Miso, white (shiro)	2 tbsp / 36 g
Mirin	1 tbsp
Sake	1 tbsp
Soy sauce	2 tsp
Rice vinegar	1 tsp
Ginger, peeled and finely grated	1 tsp
TO SERVE	
Lemon, in wedges	1

Prep Phase

1. Salt lightly, weighting the ½ tsp toward the underside — that face takes no glaze and would otherwise be unseasoned. The miso and soy carry the exterior salt load; do not add more.
2. Rest skin-down on a rack over a plate, uncovered, fridge, 15 minutes. This runs during the oven preheat at no attention cost. Skip it freely if you walk in late, or if the portions were already salted and held uncovered overnight, in which case that rest has done the work.
3. Whisk miso, mirin, sake, soy, rice vinegar and ginger to a smooth, pourable paste.
4. Line the sheet pan with parchment. This is mandatory for the salmon — the glaze welds to bare metal and burns onto it.

Active Cooking

5. Blot both faces dry. The surface must read matte, not beaded.
6. Brush the glaze thinly and evenly over top and sides — roughly two-thirds of it. Do not let it pool on the parchment.
7. At T-15, lay skin-down on the clear end of the tray alongside the broccolini. Roast 9–11 minutes.
8. **Pull at 122°F / 50°C** at the thickest point — probed horizontally into the centre of the thickest portion. This is the controlling trigger; these portions are cut to uniform thickness precisely so placement is reliable. Carries approximately 3°F / 2°C to a finished 125°F / 52°C.

Corroborative only: the portion should give slightly under light pressure at the thickest point without separating. Do not pull it open to check — it damages the glaze, and translucency varies with species and fat.

Holding & Assembly

9. Rest uncovered on warm plates, 3–4 minutes. At a 2°C delta the rest is doing almost no thermal work — its job is letting the glaze set from tacky to firm and giving a clean release from the skin. Do not tent; trapped steam slackens the glaze.
10. To plate, slide a fish slice between flesh and skin and lift. The skin and rendered subcutaneous layer stay on the parchment. Lemon wedges to the table.

Critical Control Points

Class	Failure Mode	Sensory Cue	Recovery
Critical	Glaze scorches — coat applied too thick, or glaze pooled on the parchment	Surface goes from glossy amber to matte dark brown at the thin edges; smells acrid rather than sweet	Unrecoverable — bitterness carries into the flesh. Prevent: thin coat, lower-middle rack
Major (b)	Overcooked — pulled past 122°F / 50°C	White albumin beading heavily across the surface	Unrecoverable for texture; dish remains serviceable. Lemon compensates for lost moisture

Class	Failure Mode	Sensory Cue	Recovery
			perception
Major	Portion tears on lift — flesh grips the pan	Fish slice meets resistance and the flesh begins to shear rather than release	Prevented by parchment. Without it, serve the torn portion to yourself

Adjust: if the plated fish reads flat, add lemon rather than salt — the glaze carries the salt load. If it reads sweet, lemon again; vinegar stacks with the glaze.

2 · Roasted Broccolini, Sesame

Yield: 3 · Total: ~18 min · Active: ~5 min · Oven: 425°F / 218°C

Blistered stems with charred floret tips — the firm counterweight to the soft salmon and rice.

Ingredient	Amount
Broccolini, unpeeled, ½ in / 1 cm of woody stem trimmed	12 oz / 340 g
Oil, neutral	1½ tbsp / 20 g
Salt, Diamond Crystal kosher	½ tsp
OFF-HEAT FINISH	
Sesame oil, toasted	½ tsp
Sesame seeds, toasted	1 tsp

Prep Phase

- Trim ½ in / 1 cm of woody stem. Leave unpeeled — the skins are tender at this thickness and hold the char. Halve any stem thicker than ½ in / 1 cm lengthwise.

Active Cooking

- Toss with the neutral oil and salt on the parchment-lined half-sheet. Spread across one end in as close to a single layer as the space allows, leaving the other end clear for the salmon. Parchment is the default — it costs a little contact char and buys much easier cleanup and no stuck florets. For maximum char, use a second bare pan.
- In at T-20. Total 14–16 minutes, including the brief T-15 tray-out.
- Primary cue:** stems yield to a paring knife with light resistance and floret tips are blackened at the edges. Still rigid at 16 minutes means the end was crowded — give it 3 more.

Holding & Assembly

- Into a warm bowl. Toss with the sesame oil and seeds off-heat, while hot — the oil's aromatics degrade at 425°F and it must not go on before roasting.
- Hold uncovered, ~15–20 minutes. Covering steams the char away.

Critical Control Points

Class	Failure Mode	Sensory Cue	Recovery
Major	Crowded end — broccolini steams rather than roasts	Reads wet and dull green rather than blistered at 12 minutes	Recoverable: spread onto a second pan and continue 4 minutes

Adjust: if under-seasoned, a pinch of salt while hot.

3 · Cucumber Sunomono

Yield: 3 · Total: ~20 min (15 passive) · Active: ~5 min · No heat

Cool, sharp, crisp-tender — the palate reset against the miso. Not optional; it is the named relieving component for the salmon's richness.

Ingredient	Amount
Cucumbers, Japanese or Persian, unpeeled, sliced 2 mm	2
Salt, Diamond Crystal kosher	1 tsp
Rice vinegar	2 tbsp + 2 tsp
Sugar	1 tsp
Sesame seeds, toasted	1 tsp

Prep Phase

1. Slice the cucumbers 2 mm, unpeeled — the thin skin supplies the snap and colour.
2. Toss with the salt; drain in a colander 15 minutes.
3. Squeeze gently but thoroughly — press the water out without compacting the slices, and stop while they still hold a distinct snap. Do not squeeze to a halved volume; that produces a yielding salad and loses the contrast the plate needs.
4. Dissolve the sugar in the vinegar, toss through, add the sesame seeds.

Holding & Assembly

5. Sealed, fridge, ~30 minutes designed. Because the slices are deliberately left wetter than a hard-squeezed sunomono, they continue to release water and the dressing dilutes faster.
6. Drain at T-3 before serving. Mandatory, not conditional.

Critical control points: not applicable — no heat, no irreversible step.

Adjust: if too sharp, a further $\frac{1}{4}$ tsp sugar. Do not add water.

4 · Steamed Japanese Short-Grain Rice

Yield: ~6–7 half-cup portions · Total: ~50 min · Active: ~3 min · Tiger, Plain setting

Neutral carrier by design. Meal-level texture exemption: rice is inherently single-texture; contrast is provided by the broccolini and cucumber.

Ingredient	Amount
Rice, Japanese short-grain	1½ cooker cups / ~225 g dry
Water	To cooker line 1½

Active Cooking

1. Rinse under cold water, swirling and draining 4–5 times, until the water runs near-clear.
2. Water to the cooker's line 1½. Plain setting. Start at T-60 — this is the critical path.

Holding & Assembly

3. Keep Warm, lid closed. Holds indefinitely.
4. Fluff at T-3, lid straight back on. Portion moderate for Jin and Hui Fong, full for Lukas; the modest surplus is intentional and reheats well.

Critical control points: not applicable — single-step preparation with no irreversible failure point.

Adjust: *none applicable post-cook; hydration is fixed at the cooker line.*